



New York State Regents Examination in English Language Arts

Part 3 Rubric

Text Analysis: Exposition

Criteria	4 Responses at this Level:	3 Responses at this Level:	2 Responses at this Level:	1 Responses at this Level:
Content and Analysis: the extent to which the response conveys complex ideas and information clearly and accurately in order to respond to the task and support an analysis of the text	-introduce a well-reasoned central idea and a writing strategy that clearly establish the criteria for analysis -demonstrate a thoughtful analysis of the author's use of the writing strategy to develop the central idea	-introduce a clear central idea and a writing strategy that establish the criteria for analysis -demonstrate an appropriate analysis of the author's use of the writing strategy to develop the central idea	-introduce a central idea and/or a writing strategy -demonstrate a superficial analysis of the author's use of the writing strategy to develop the central idea	-introduce a confused or incomplete central idea or writing strategy and/or -demonstrate a minimal analysis of the author's use of the writing strategy to develop the central idea
Command of Evidence: the extent to which the response presents evidence from the provided text to support analysis	-present ideas clearly and consistently, making effective use of specific and relevant evidence to support analysis	-present ideas sufficiently, making adequate use of relevant evidence to support analysis	-present ideas inconsistently, inadequately, and/or inaccurately in an attempt to support analysis, making use of some evidence that may be irrelevant	-present little or no evidence from the text
Coherence, Organization, and Style: the extent to which the response logically organizes complex ideas, concepts, and information using formal style and precise language	-exhibit logical organization of ideas and information to create a cohesive and coherent response -establish and maintain a formal style, using precise language and sound structure	-exhibit acceptable organization of ideas and information to create a coherent response -establish and maintain a formal style, using appropriate language and structure	-exhibit inconsistent organization of ideas and information, failing to create a coherent response -lack a formal style, using language that is basic, inappropriate, or imprecise	-exhibit little organization of ideas and information -use language that is predominantly incoherent, inappropriate, or copied directly from the task or text -are minimal, making assessment unreliable
Control of Conventions: the extent to which the response demonstrates command of conventions of standard English grammar, usage, capitalization, punctuation, and spelling	-demonstrate control of conventions with infrequent errors	-demonstrate partial control of conventions with occasional errors that do not hinder comprehension	-demonstrate emerging control of conventions with some errors that hinder comprehension	-demonstrate a lack of control of conventions with frequent errors that make comprehension difficult -are minimal, making assessment of conventions unreliable

- A response that is a personal response and makes little or no reference to the task or text can be scored no higher than a 1.
- A response that is totally copied from the text with no original writing must be given a 0.
- A response that is totally unrelated to the task, illegible, incoherent, blank, or unrecognizable as English must be scored a 0.

In The Good Earth by Pearl S. Buck, the intricate details of a rising Chinese family's life are being displayed before the readers which leads them to an understanding of the central idea that while one may bathe and bask in their new-found prosperity, they must still honor the traditions of their past. Pearl S. Buck demonstrates this through the characterization of Wang Lung in showing how, while he may have adopted some characteristics reflective of his rise in status, he also remained faithful to the cultural traditions of his past.

The text begins with the reader witnessing Wang Lung's honoring of the Chinese New Year by adhering to a number of traditions. He buys "squares of red paper on which were brushed in gilt ink the letter for happiness and some with the letter for riches, and these squares he pasted upon his farm utensils to bring him luck in the new year." He pays homage to the gods, dressing them and burning incense before them in the temple and burning candles beneath a photo of a god in his home. These acts reflect his faith and loyalty to his cultural beliefs and traditions.

The tradition of making moon cakes as part of the New Year's celebration reveals other aspects of Wang Lung's character. He buys the "best...sugar and lard" for his wife to make these and, when she has completed them, colorfully decorating some, he "felt his heart burst with pride". Here we begin to see first a rationalized consideration for others as he rejects the idea of displaying these to other family members in the words, "But prosperity had made Wang Lung cautious. One could

not ask hungry people only to see cakes". This then evolves into an air of superiority as he is well aware that his social status is on the rise which is reflected in the line, "He had himself seen to it that the colored cakes were put away into the basket lest he might have to offer them to common men". These traits of pride and superiority are further witnessed when he is described as being "pleased that to the great hall where he had stood with so much timidity and in such poverty his wife should now go as a visitor" as he, his wife, and son go to the House of Huang well-dressed and bearing "rich" gifts of colorfully decorated moon cakes. These traits culminate in his response to the gate keeper's acknowledgement of his rising good fortune where he "answered negligently as one speaks to a man who is scarcely an equal".

All in all, Wang Lung is a complex man – a man of faith and loyalty who honors his culture's traditions and beliefs. He also is a proud man – proud of his wife's abilities and proud of his achievements that have taken him up a notch in status. Unfortunately, with the latter, there may also be a growing air of superiority developing towards those he is now beginning to see as "Common".

Anchor Level 4–A

CONTENT AND ANALYSIS:

- The response introduces a well-reasoned central idea (*In The Good Earth by Pearl S. Buck, the intricate details of a rising Chinese family’s life are being displayed before the readers which leads them to an understanding of the central idea that while one may bathe and bask in their new-found prosperity, they must still honor the traditions of their past*) and a writing strategy (*Pearl S. Buck demonstrates this through the characterization of Wang Lung*) that clearly establish the criteria for analysis.
- The response demonstrates a thoughtful analysis of the author’s use of characterization to develop the central idea (*These acts reflect his faith and loyalty to his cultural beliefs and traditions; Here we begin to see first a rationalized consideration for others as he rejects the idea of displaying these to other family members and This then evolves into an air of superiority*).

COMMAND OF EVIDENCE:

- The response presents ideas clearly and consistently, making effective use of specific and relevant evidence to support analysis (*He buys “squares of red paper on which were brushed in gilt ink the letter for happiness ... and these squares he pasted upon his farm utensils to bring him luck in the new year”; “But prosperity had made Wang Lung cautious. One could not ask hungry people only to see cakes”; These traits culminate in his response ... where he “answered negligently as one speaks to a man who is scarcely an equal”*).

COHERENCE, ORGANIZATION, AND STYLE:

- The response exhibits logical organization of ideas and information to create a cohesive and coherent response, with an opening paragraph that introduces the central idea and the writing strategy of characterization, followed by two body paragraphs that focus on how Wang Lung’s *adhering to a number of traditions* reveals how his rise from poverty has affected his character, and a summative conclusion that reinforces the central idea and writing strategy (*All in all, Wang Lung is a complex man—a man of faith and loyalty who honors his culture’s traditions and beliefs. He also is a proud man ... there may also be a growing air of superiority developing towards those he is now beginning to see as “common”*).
- The response establishes and maintains a formal style, using precise language and sound structure (*He pays homage to the gods, dressing them and burning incense before them in the temple and burning candles beneath a photo of a god in his home and The tradition of making moon cakes as part of the New Year’s celebration reveals other aspects of Wang Lung’s character*).

CONTROL OF CONVENTIONS:

- The response demonstrates control of conventions with infrequent errors.

The central idea of "The Good Earth" by Pearl S. Buck is tradition. This central idea is conveyed and amplified by Buck's use of imagery. Imagery is an integral part of the story. For instance, the text states, "and then upon the doors of his house he pasted long strips of red paper brushed with mottoes of good luck, and over his doorway he pasted a fringe of red paper cunningly cut into a flower pattern and very finely cut" (line 6-9). This vivid description of Wang Lung's house contributes to the central idea of tradition as it describes the amount of effort Lung puts into decorating the house for New Year's. This tradition is important as it signifies the prosperity of the past year and Wang Lung makes sure to honor this tradition by making the finest decorations. Along with this, the use of imagery emphasizes the use of red which signifies celebration.

The central idea is further amplified later in the passage through the use of imagery. For example, on lines 55-57 the text states "Wang Lung dressed himself quickly while his wife combed out afresh her long black hair and knotted it with the brass pin washed with silver which he had bought for her, and she put on her new coat of black". This imagery shows the amount of preparation that is put into how one appears during New Year's celebrations and how to honor the day. New clothes are worn to signify his new found prosperity as he dresses according to his new status.

Anchor Level 4–B

CONTENT AND ANALYSIS:

- The response introduces a clear central idea (*The central idea of The Good Earth by Pearl S. Buck is tradition*) and a writing strategy (*This central idea is conveyed and amplified by Buck’s use of imagery*) to develop the central idea.
- The response demonstrates appropriate analysis of the author’s use of imagery to develop the central idea (*This vivid description of Wang Lung’s house contributes to the central idea of tradition as it describes the amount of effort Lung puts into decorating the house for New Year’s and This imagery shows the amount of preparation that is put into how one appears during New Year’s celebrations*).

COMMAND OF EVIDENCE:

- The response presents ideas clearly and consistently, making effective use of specific and relevant evidence to support analysis (“*And then upon the doors of his house he pasted long strips of red paper ... and over his doorway he pasted a fringe of red paper cunningly cut into a flower pattern and very finely cut*” and “*Wang Lung dressed himself quickly while his wife combed out afresh her long black hair and knotted it with the brass pin washed with silver ... and she put on her new coat of black*”).

COHERENCE, ORGANIZATION, AND STYLE:

- The response exhibits logical organization of ideas and information to create a cohesive and coherent response, comprised of two paragraphs, the first of which identifies the central idea and writing strategy and then continues on to exemplify images that reflect traditional behavior associated with Wang Lung’s culture (*Wang Lung makes sure to honor this tradition by making the finest decorations*), and the second which focuses on the *amount of preparation* relating to dressing to honor the New Year and to signify the *new found prosperity* it has brought him.
- The response establishes and maintains a formal style, using precise language and sound structure (*Imagery is an integral part of the story and New clothes are worn to signify his new found prosperity as he dresses according to his new status*).

CONTROL OF CONVENTIONS:

- The response demonstrates control of conventions with infrequent errors.

In this passage we see a Chinese family during the New Year. We learn that Wang Lung enjoys preparing for the New Year, and decorates his house and personal items with meaningful symbols. As we continue to read we are aware that Wang Lung and his family have overcome poverty and this is their first New Year with this new prosperity. As we read we can see a developing central idea of feeling pride for ones family after overcoming a difficult time. This central idea can be seen being developed by hyperbole.

First we can see the central idea presented in the line, "When the cakes were laid out upon the table in strips, ready for heating, Wang Lung felt his heart fit to burst with pride". This hyperbole of his heart bursting helps to develop this idea of pride. He is so happy for his and his family's success. He feels this accomplishment, even though it's just cake, is a huge way from where they once were, and signifies they have succeeded. Furthermore, we can see the central idea presented in the line, "... and in such poverty his wife should now go as a visitor, carrying his son, and cakes made as those were with the best flour and sugar and lard". The hyperbole of the best flour, sugar, and lard helps to further develop the idea of pride. He says that in the past they have been poor, but now although he personally isn't going to present the cakes, his family gets to experience this honor that he didn't. Furthermore, he

Anchor Paper – Part 3 – Level 3 – A

feels pride that his son gets to go to the hall with pride, even though he himself did not. Both of these lines show the ~~central~~ central idea of feeling pride for ones family after overcoming a difficult time. They show how proud Wang Lung is and how he feels pride for his family.

Anchor Level 3–A

CONTENT AND ANALYSIS:

- The response introduces a well-reasoned central idea of *feeling pride for ones family after overcoming a difficult time* and a writing strategy (*This Central Idea can be seen being developed by hyperbole*) that clearly establish the criteria for analysis.
- The response demonstrates an appropriate analysis of the author’s use of hyperbole to develop the central idea (*This hyperbole of his heart bursting helps to develop this idea of pride ... He feels this accomplishment ... is a huge way from where they once were*).

COMMAND OF EVIDENCE:

- The response presents ideas sufficiently, making adequate use of relevant evidence to support analysis (*Futhermore, we can see the central idea presented in the line, “... and in such poverty his wife should now go as a visitor, carrying his son, and cakes made as these were with the best flour and sugar and lard” and He says that in the past they have been poor, but now although he personally isn’t going to present the cakes, his family gets to experience this honor that he didn’t. Furthermore, he feels pride that his son gets to go to the hall with pride, even though he himself did not*).

COHERENCE, ORGANIZATION, AND STYLE:

- The response exhibits logical organization of ideas and information to create a cohesive and coherent response, with an opening paragraph that introduces the context of the story, the central idea and a writing strategy, and a second paragraph that discusses how the use of hyperbole illustrates the central idea. The second paragraph concludes with a summary sentence (*Both of these lines show the Central Idea of feeling pride for ones family after overcoming a difficult time*).
- The response establishes and maintains a formal style, using appropriate language and structure (*We learn that Wang Lung enjoys preparing for the New Year, and decorates his house and personal items with meaningful symbols; First we can see the Central Idea presented; Furthermore, he feels pride*).

CONTROL OF CONVENTIONS:

- The response demonstrates partial control of conventions with occasional errors (*As we read we; Central Idea; ones family; reeady; familys success; signifys; succeded*) that do not hinder comprehension.

The story, *The Good Earth*, follows Wang Lung and his New Year's celebration through his Chinese culture. The author, Pearl S. Buck, uses writing strategies, such as structure, to display the central idea. She uses structure ~~the~~ to tell that hard work will always be noticed.

The author ~~the~~ illustrates the central idea by structuring the story in chronological order. In the beginning, the story is introduced with preparations of the New Year's celebration. For example, the author writes that Wang Lung goes into town to buy "squares of red paper on which were brushed in gilt into the letter for happiness and ~~some~~ some with the letter for riches..." Then, as the story progresses, the author writes about Wang Lung's preparations for his cake and the days leading up to the ~~the~~ New Year. On the first day of the New Year, Wang Lung hid his cakes to ensure it was not seen before the Old Mistress of the great house had seen them. Finally, on the day to present the gates, the text ends with the gateman of the great house ~~the~~ acknowledging Wang Lung's efforts. The author writes that Wang Lung "had his reverend at the great gate of the House of Huang" and that he "stepped with assurance inside the gate," after ~~the~~ meeting the gateman. Without the author structuring the story in chronological order, the reader would have misunderstood the central idea of the text.

Overall, the story, *The Good Earth*, written by Pearl S. Buck, demonstrates the central idea that hard work ~~the~~ will always be noticed. With the use of the author's writing strategies, such as structure, ~~the~~ she was able to convey the message to the reader with ease. By ordering the story chronologically, it allowed the reader to understand the central theme told by the author.

Anchor Level 3–B

CONTENT AND ANALYSIS:

- The response introduces a clear central idea (*hard work will always be noticed*) and a writing strategy (*The author, Pearl S. Buck, uses ... structure to display the central idea*) that establish the criteria for analysis.
- The response demonstrates a superficial analysis of the author’s use of structure to develop the central idea (*The author illustrates the central idea by structuring the story in chronological order and Without the author structuring the story in chronological order, the reader would have misunderstood the central idea of the text*), recounting plot events in order without providing meaningful analysis.

COMMAND OF EVIDENCE:

- The response presents ideas inconsistently and inadequately, in an attempt to support analysis, presenting a balance of evidence neither related to hard work (*the author writes that Wang Lung goes into town to buy “squares of red paper on which were brushed in gilt ink the letter for happiness and some with the letter for riches...”*) nor illustrating the relationship of chronological order to the selected central idea (*By ordering the story chronologically, it allowed the reader to understand the central theme told by the author*).

COHERENCE, ORGANIZATION, AND STYLE:

- The response exhibits an acceptable organization of ideas and information to create a coherent response, with an introductory paragraph that presents a writing strategy and central idea, followed by a second paragraph consisting of a chronological recounting of plot events using text excerpts, and concludes with a third paragraph that reiterates a central idea and writing strategy.
- The response establishes and maintains a formal style, using appropriate language and structure (*On the first day of the New Year, Wang Lung hid his cakes to ensure it was not seen before the Old Mistress of the great house had seen them and With the use of the author’s writing strategies, such as structure, she was able to convey the message to the reader with ease*), with one inexact word choice of *gates*, likely for “cakes.”

CONTROL OF CONVENTIONS:

- The response demonstrates partial control of conventions with occasional errors that do not hinder comprehension (*The story, The Good Earth; cakes...it; author*).

The central idea is how Chinese culture celebrate New Year. The author uses conflict. Conflict is when there's a struggle with two people or two things. Conflict supports my theme because in lines (2-5) it states, "Wang Hong went into the town to the candlemaker's shop and he bought squares of red paper on which were brushed in gold ink the letter for happiness and some with the letter for richness, 財". This means that the rich celebrate with nice ~~foods~~^{desserts} with gold on them. This shows conflict on the other half because the people don't feel they're rich enough to eat them. In lines (32-33) it states, "We are not rich enough to eat white sugar and lard.". I chose conflict because it shows you the struggles between the 2 situations.

Anchor Level 2–A

CONTENT AND ANALYSIS:

- The response introduces a central idea (*The central idea is how Chines culture celabrate New Years*) and a writing strategy (*The author uses conflict*).
- The response demonstrates a superficial analysis of the author's use of conflict to develop the writing strategy (*This shows conflict on the other haff because the people don't feel theyer rich enough to eat them*).

COMMAND OF EVIDENCE:

- The response presents ideas inconsistently, inadequately and inaccurately, mistaking the buying of *squares of red paper on which were brushed in guilt ink the letter for happiness and some with the letter for richness* with the decorations Wang Lung's wife put on the moon cakes and, thus, is not representative of the analysis that follows, although the second example is appropriate (*"We are not rich enough to eat white sugar and lard"*).

COHERENCE, ORGANIZATION, AND STYLE:

- The response exhibits inconsistent organization of ideas and information, with a single paragraph that first introduces a central idea and writing strategy, then a misinterpreted quote that does not support the analysis that follows, and a second quote that attempts to connect the central idea and writing strategy, closing with a sentence of rationale in choosing conflict as the writing strategy (*because it shows you the struggles between the 2 sitations*).
- The response lacks a formal style, using language that is basic and imprecise (*The author uses conflict. Conflict is when there's a struggle; deserts for "desserts"; shows conflict on the other haff; 2 for "two"*).

CONTROL OF CONVENTIONS:

- The response demonstrates partial control of conventions with occasional errors (*Chines; celabrate; New Years; struggle; lines (2–5); guilt; richness; haff; theyer; them, In; lard. .; sitations*) that do not hinder comprehension.

The central idea of the story is that good things will come to the end. Wanglung was in town and went to a candlemaker store and saw a cake store. Wang ask the baker who was the cakes for and she said it was for the Grand house. Later on he gets asked to help with the cakes in the grand house.

A writing strategy the author used was setting. The setting plays a big role in the writing because we know exactly where we are and what is taking place. It also tells us that China is recovering from poverty and is rebuilding.

Anchor Level 2–B

CONTENT AND ANALYSIS:

- The response introduces a confused central idea (*The Central Idea of the Story is that good thing will come to the end*) and a writing strategy (*A writing strategy the aurther used was setting*).
- The response demonstrates minimal analysis of the author's use of setting to develop the central idea (*The setting plays a big role in the writing because we know exaticy where we are and what is taking place*).

COMMAND OF EVIDENCE:

- The response presents ideas inadequately and inaccurately (*Wang ask the baker who was the cakes for and she said it was for the Grand house. Later on he gets asked to help with the cakes in the grand house*), making use of some evidence that may be irrelevant (*It also tells us that China is recovering from poverty and rebuiting*).

COHERENCE, ORGANIZATION, AND STYLE:

- The response exhibits inconsistent organization of ideas and information, failing to create a coherent response, consisting of two paragraphs, the first of which introduces a central idea that is followed by a series of inaccurate statements and the second which introduces a writing strategy with no specific support or explanation as to how it is used to develop the central idea *that good thing will come to the end*.
- The response lacks a formal style, using language that is basic (*plays a big role*) and imprecise (*thing will come to the end*).

CONTROL OF CONVENTIONS:

- The response demonstrates emerging control of conventions with some errors (*Central Idea; wented; Wong ask the; who was the; cakes...it; house. Later on he; gets asked; aurther; exaticy; rebuiting*) that hinder comprehension.

The central idea of the text is about making resolutions for the New Year even though you won't keep them.

It sounds good to say you're going to exercise more and lose weight but we know that won't last long. The truth is the best part about New Year's is the party with friends and family though it can get confusing trying to remember that you have to write in new numbers if you have to fill out the date on a form or something.

Anchor Level 1–A

CONTENT AND ANALYSIS:

- The response introduces a confused central idea, unrelated to the task or texts (*The central idea of the text is about making resolutions for the New Year even though you won't keep them*) but does not introduce a writing strategy.
- The response demonstrates no analysis of the author's use of a writing strategy.

COMMAND OF EVIDENCE:

- The response presents no evidence from the text beyond incidentally using the term *New Year*.

COHERENCE, ORGANIZATION, AND STYLE:

- The response exhibits inconsistent organization of ideas and information, failing to create a coherent response, consisting of a single paragraph that moves from a central idea about New Year's resolutions, to *the best part about New Year's is the party*, to the confusion of remembering to write the new date.
- The essay lacks a formal style, using language that is basic (*It sounds good to say; the best part; you have to write in new numbers if you have to fill out the date on a form or something*) and inappropriate with the use of the second person "you" throughout.

CONTROL OF CONVENTIONS:

- The response demonstrates control of conventions with infrequent errors (*weight but*).

* CONDITION CODE:

Although the response exhibits Level 1, Level 2, and Level 4 criteria, it is a personal response, making little reference to the task or text and can be scored no higher than a 1.

The central idea in this passage is that good earth in new year. The principal character in the history is new year, because in every house the people celebrate ~~celebrate~~ new year in family. In line (2) show that "The new year approached and in every house in the village there were preparations." This shows that in all house village the preparation.

Anchor Level 1–B

CONTENT AND ANALYSIS:

- The response introduces a confused central idea (*The central idea in this passage is that good Earth in New Year*).
- The response demonstrates no analysis of the author’s use of a writing strategy.

COMMAND OF EVIDENCE:

- The response presents little evidence from the text, with one quote connected to the central idea only in that it mentions the New Year (“*The New Year approached and in every house in the village there were preparations*”).

COHERENCE, ORGANIZATION, AND STYLE:

- The response exhibits little organization of ideas and information, consisting of one paragraph of loosely connected sentences relating to the *New Year*.
- The response uses language that is predominantly incoherent (*good Earth in New Year; character in the history is New Year; New Year in family; village the preparation*).

CONTROL OF CONVENTIONS:

- The response demonstrates a lack of control of conventions with frequent errors (*good Earth; pricipal; celebry; In line (1) show; This shows that in all house*) that make comprehension difficult.

In this excerpt from *The Good Earth* by Pearl S. Buck, one central idea that is evident is materialism. The main character, Wang Lung, spends the days leading up to the Chinese New Year by purchasing new clothes, decorations, and expensive ingredients for his wife to cook with. It's not an greedy materialistic outlook that Lung holds, but rather, one that developed out of previous misfortune. For the second day of the New Year, "Wang Lung dressed himself quickly while his wife... put on her new coat of black that was made from the same piece as his own new robe, twenty-four good feet of cloth for the two, and two feet of cloth thrown in for good measure, as the custom is at cloth shops" (Line 55). The fact that Wang Lung is dressing his family so nicely this year indicates that he hadn't been able to before, and he's taking advantage of the changing situation and allowing himself to make these purchases, requiring a very materialistic lens.

Buck develops this central idea by using the literary element of conflict, or rather the lack of it. It ~~is~~ can be inferred that Wang Lung and his family were previously subject to poverty, which offers some explanation as to why he is buying so many materialistic ~~things~~ goods for the New Year. Because of the conflict he once faced, he now feels completely ~~free~~ free with some shred of financial freedom. In line 36, Buck writes that, "Wang Lung was pleased that to the great hall where he had stood with so much timidity and in such poverty his wife should now go as visitor, carrying his son, dressed in red, and cakes made as these were with the best flour and sugar and lard". Wang Lung is taking pride in what we might call fleeting things, but they are so important to him because they had been out of his reach for so long. Because of his

past struggles with poverty, the new lack of concern (prosperity) in his life led him to indulge in materialistic practices. Buck effectively uses his former adversity to show how, or rather why Wang Lung became a man so concerned with the appearance of his family, buying countless decorations and new clothes for his family for a holiday, simply because, unlike the year before, now he could.

In the Good Earth, an excerpt by Pearl S. Buck it ~~any~~ shows a situation about a Chinese family during the holidays, how they have prospered over the years. Before they were all going through poverty making them not have enough food for the entire family to eat and be healthy. They suffered tremendously, but once they began to harvest and thought of a good income they did nonetheless and became to do it on a daily. This showing the central idea that if you are suffering economically and have nothing at all, have perseverance. And the author shows this message through the use of imagery.

Wong Long the first person in the story has absolutely nothing but wants to do something, spend for the holidays with that he decides to go to ~~the market~~ ^{market} and make bread. "... for more than anything he wished to enter the house with great pride" (line 49) - this makes us imagine that although Long has a bit to give as they are still slowly getting out of the poor and going through poverty lifestyle it's important to know that no matter how difficult a situation can be, don't lose perseverance. It's always something important to strive for a good ending to any bad situation. "Good harvest and he stepped with ease out the gate" (line 69). The fact that Wong never gave up no matter how hard his situation economically was shows a lot about who he is and imagery helped with this message the author wanted to portray.

The New Year approached and in every house in the village there were preparations. Wang Lung went into the town to the candlemakers shop and he bought squares of red paper on which were brushed in gilt ink the letter for happiness and some with the letter for riches, and these squares he pasted upon his farm utensils to bring him luck, and over his doorway he pasted a fringe of red paper cunningly cut into a flower pattern, and very finely cut. And he bought red paper to make new dresses for the gods and this the old man did cleverly enough for his old shaking hands, and Wang Lung took them and put them upon the two small gods in the temple to the earth and he burned a little incense before them ~~upon~~ for the sake of the new year. and for his ~~sake~~ house he bought also two red candles to burn on the eve of the year upon the table under the picture of a god, which was pasted on the wall of the middle room above where the table stood.

And Wang Lung went again into the town and he bought pork fat and white sugar and the woman rendered the fat smooth and white and she took rice flower which they had ground from their own rice...

The excerpt "The Good Earth" written in 1931 speaks on the experiences of Chinese culture on New Years from the perspective of a traditional family. The families experiences conveys their struggles of poverty and how they overcame it. The central idea of this excerpt is to always be grateful for what you have no matter the circumstances. The literary element used in this excerpt is point of view. This excerpt conveys the families experiences from their own viewpoints.

The author uses point of view in order to display the young Chinese family's circumstances and their status in society. "The Good Earth" writes those are not for us to eat, beyond one or two of the plain ones for guests to taste. We aren't rich enough to eat white sugar and lard. I am preparing them for the Old Mistress at the great house" (Book, lines 32-34) This emphasizes on the difference in social class. In this case the family is low class while the Old Mistress is high class. The family is preparing food for the Mistress as a way of showing their respect to the higher ups. This displays point of view because in the young families perspective, preparing food for the Mistress is a way of showing their gratitude due to them being lower in status to the mistress. The central idea connects to the excerpt because it indicates how appreciative the young family is towards one another. Even

though they aren't the wealthiest, they still make the best out of what they have. "The Good Earth" states "Wang Lung felt his heart fit to burst with pride. There was no other woman in the village able to do what his had done, to make cakes such as only the rich ate the feast" (Buck, lines 20-23). This goes to show Wang Lung's gratefulness towards his wife. He acknowledges how good of a cook she is and doesn't compare her to the other women in the village. This also ties back to point of view because in Wang Lung's perspective, his wife is the best cook throughout the village. His viewpoint of his wife shows his gratefulness towards her for what she does best.

In conclusion, the central idea connects with this excerpt because it displays the idea of being grateful and appreciative of what you have. Having a positive mindset despite the circumstances in your life is what was shown in the experiences of the young Chinese traditional family. Overall, be thankful for what you have and also for the people in your life despite the hardships and challenges you face.

New Years is a symbolism as to reflect on their prosperity.

Practice Paper A – Score Level 4

Holistically, this response best fits the criteria for Level 4. The response introduces a well-reasoned central idea and a writing strategy that clearly establish the criteria for analysis while demonstrating a thoughtful analysis of the author’s use of conflict to develop the central idea. The response presents ideas clearly and consistently, making effective use of specific and relevant evidence to support analysis. The response exhibits logical organization of ideas to create a cohesive and coherent response that establishes and maintains a formal style, using precise language and sound structure and demonstrating control of the conventions with infrequent errors.

Practice Paper B – Score Level 2

Holistically, this response best fits the criteria for Level 2. The response introduces a central idea and a writing strategy that demonstrate a superficial analysis of the author’s use of imagery to develop the central idea. The response presents ideas inconsistently, inadequately, and inaccurately in an attempt to support analysis. The response exhibits inconsistent organization of ideas and information, failing to create a coherent response and lacks a formal style, using language that is basic and imprecise that demonstrates emerging control of conventions with some errors that hinder comprehension.

Practice Paper C – Score Level 0

Holistically, this response best fits the criteria for Level 0. The response is totally copied from the text with no original writing.

Practice Paper D – Score Level 3

Holistically, this response best fits the criteria for Level 3. The response introduces a clear central idea and writing strategy that establishes the criteria for analysis and demonstrates an appropriate analysis of point of view to develop the central idea. The response presents ideas sufficiently, making adequate use of relevant evidence to support analysis and exhibits acceptable organization of ideas and information to create a coherent response while maintaining a formal style, using appropriate language and structure. The response demonstrates partial control of conventions with errors that do not hinder comprehension.

Practice Paper E – Score Level 1

Holistically, this response best fits the criteria for Level 1. The response introduces a confused central idea and writing strategy, demonstrating no analysis of the author’s use of symbolism to develop the central idea. The response presents little evidence from the text and is minimal, making assessment of organization, language and conventions unreliable.

Map to the Learning Standards
Regents Examination in English Language Arts
August 2025

Question	Type	Credit	Weight	Standard
1	MC	1	1	RL.2 (11-12)
2	MC	1	1	RL.3 (11-12)
3	MC	1	1	RL.3 (11-12)
4	MC	1	1	RL.4 (11-12)
5	MC	1	1	RL.6 (11-12)
6	MC	1	1	L.4 (11-12)
7	MC	1	1	RL.3 (11-12)
8	MC	1	1	L.5 (11-12)
9	MC	1	1	RL.5 (11-12)
10	MC	1	1	L.5 (11-12)
11	MC	1	1	RL.4 (11-12)
12	MC	1	1	L.5 (11-12)
13	MC	1	1	RL.5 (11-12)
14	MC	1	1	RL.5 (11-12)
15	MC	1	1	RI.2 (11-12)
16	MC	1	1	L.4 (11-12)
17	MC	1	1	RI.3 (11-12)
18	MC	1	1	RI.2 (11-12)
19	MC	1	1	RI.4 (11-12)
20	MC	1	1	RI.4 (11-12)
21	MC	1	1	RI.3 (11-12)
22	MC	1	1	RI.3 (11-12)
23	MC	1	1	RI.5 (11-12)
24	MC	1	1	RI.6 (11-12)
Part 2 Argument Essay	Essay	6	4	RI.1–6&10(11–12) W.1, 4&9(11–12) L.1–6(11–12)
Part 3 Expository Response	Response	4	2	RL.1–6&10(11–12) W.2, 4&9(11–12) L.1–6(11–12)

The *Chart for Determining the Final Examination Score for the August 2025 Regents Examination in English Language Arts* will be posted on the Department's web site at: <https://www.nysed.gov/state-assessment/high-school-regents-examinations> on Tuesday, August 19, 2025. Conversion charts provided for previous administrations of the Regents Examination in English Language Arts must NOT be used to determine students' final scores for this administration.

Online Submission of Teacher Evaluations of the Test to the Department

Suggestions and feedback from teachers provide an important contribution to the test development process. The Department provides an online evaluation form for State assessments. It contains spaces for teachers to respond to several specific questions and to make suggestions. Instructions for completing the evaluation form are as follows:

1. Go to <https://www.nysed.gov/state-assessment/teacher-feedback-state-assessments>.
2. Click Regents Examinations.
3. Complete the required demographic fields.
4. Select the test title from the Regents Examination dropdown list.
5. Complete each evaluation question and provide comments in the space provided.
6. Click the SUBMIT button at the bottom of the page to submit the completed form.